2024
BUSINESS PROPOSAL

BAM-1063-OTT01-Managment Information Systems

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- **Executive Summary**

Burrito Gringo, a Mexican-inspired fast-food restaurant with multiple Ottawa locations, has become a staple in the local food service market through its commitment to authentic flavors, fresh ingredients, and quick service. As an independent chain, Burrito Gringo distinguishes itself by blending traditional recipes with modern dining experiences, focusing on quality and customer satisfaction.
To stay competitive in a fast-evolving industry, Burrito Gringo is undergoing a digital transformation aimed at optimizing operational efficiency and enhancing the customer experience. Current priorities include integrating advanced management systems, expanding digital partnerships with delivery platforms like Uber Eats and DoorDash, and enhancing inventory management using tools like Resto Soft. These efforts provide a foundation for more tech-enabled services that align with shifting customer expectations for personalization and convenience.
Looking forward, Burrito Gringo is exploring technologies such as IoT for real-time inventory and equipment monitoring, AI for customer insights and marketing personalization, and blockchain for improved supply chain transparency. The adoption of these technologies will not only reduce operational costs and food waste but also foster stronger customer trust through sustainable and traceable sourcing practices.
Burrito Gringo's strategic approach combines innovation with its established values of quality and authenticity. By continuing to invest in digital solutions and operational improvements, the company is well-positioned to lead Ottawa's fast-casual dining sector, delivering consistent, high-quality experiences while adapting to market changes.

1. Organization

1.1. Context and general information

Name and description of the company:

Name of the company: Burrito Gringo
Web Page: https://burritogringo.ca/
Industry: Food service and fast food restaurant
Branch Size: Approximately 15 employees in current location

Burrito Gringo is a Mexican-inspired fast-food company, especially focused on burritos and other popular dishes. With a business model focused on quick service and a value proposition based on fresh ingredients and authentic flavors, the company seeks to position itself in the competitive fast-food and healthy food market.

Burrito Gringo specializes in Mexican cuisine, with a particular focus on burritos and other traditional dishes. Founded in Ottawa, Canada, the company has grown to operate multiple locations in the region, including locations in Kanata North, Barrhaven, Bronson, Ottawa South, Ottawa East and Nepean.

Burrito Gringo's value proposition focuses on offering fresh, high-quality food, prepared daily. The team starts early each morning, chopping fresh cilantro, chopping ripe tomatoes, squeezing lemons and preparing guacamole. They also cook beans, season meats and mix sauces daily. Meats, such as steak, chicken, beef and pork, are grilled and slow-cooked to ensure an unparalleled flavor in every bite.

Industry, economic group, competitors, incumbents.

With over a decade of presence in the local market, Burrito Gringo has established itself as a preferred choice for those seeking vibrant flavors, unsurpassed quality and satisfying portions in Ottawa's Mexican food offerings.

Sector: Food Service
Industry: Fast Food Restaurants and Mexican Gastronomy
Economic group: Does not belong to an economical group.

Burrito Gringo operates as an independent restaurant chain and is not part of a larger economic group or multinational business network. Its business model focuses on regional expansion in and around Ottawa, with an autonomous organizational structure. This allows it to maintain direct control over its operations, quality and market strategy, differentiating itself in the local sector with a focus on authenticity and freshness in its products.

Competitors and Incumbent: Burrito Gringo is positioned in this market offering burritos and other Mexican dishes with a focus on freshness of ingredients and speed of service, seeking to differentiate itself by the quality and authenticity of its products. The following is a list of the main competitors in the city of Ottawa:

- Mucho Burrito Fresh Mexican Grill: Fast food chain offering burritos, tacos and other Mexican dishes, standing out for the customization of orders and the use of fresh ingredients.

- El Camino: Restaurant known for its tacos and modern ambiance, which has gained popularity among Ottawa residents for its focus on quality and authenticity of Mexican flavors.

- Ahora Mexican Restaurant: An establishment that offers a wide variety of Mexican dishes in a colorful and cozy atmosphere, attracting customers looking for an authentic dining experience.

- Pancho Villa: Restaurant that specializes in traditional Mexican cuisine, offering a variety of typical dishes and drinks, and has established a solid presence in Ottawa's culinary scene.

- Lone Star Texas Grill: Although its main focus is Texan cuisine, it offers a variety of Mexican and Tex-Mex dishes, appealing to a broad base of customers looking for flavors of the southwestern United States.

- Taco Bell: One of the largest companies known for Mexican food, specifically the Burritos and Tacos.

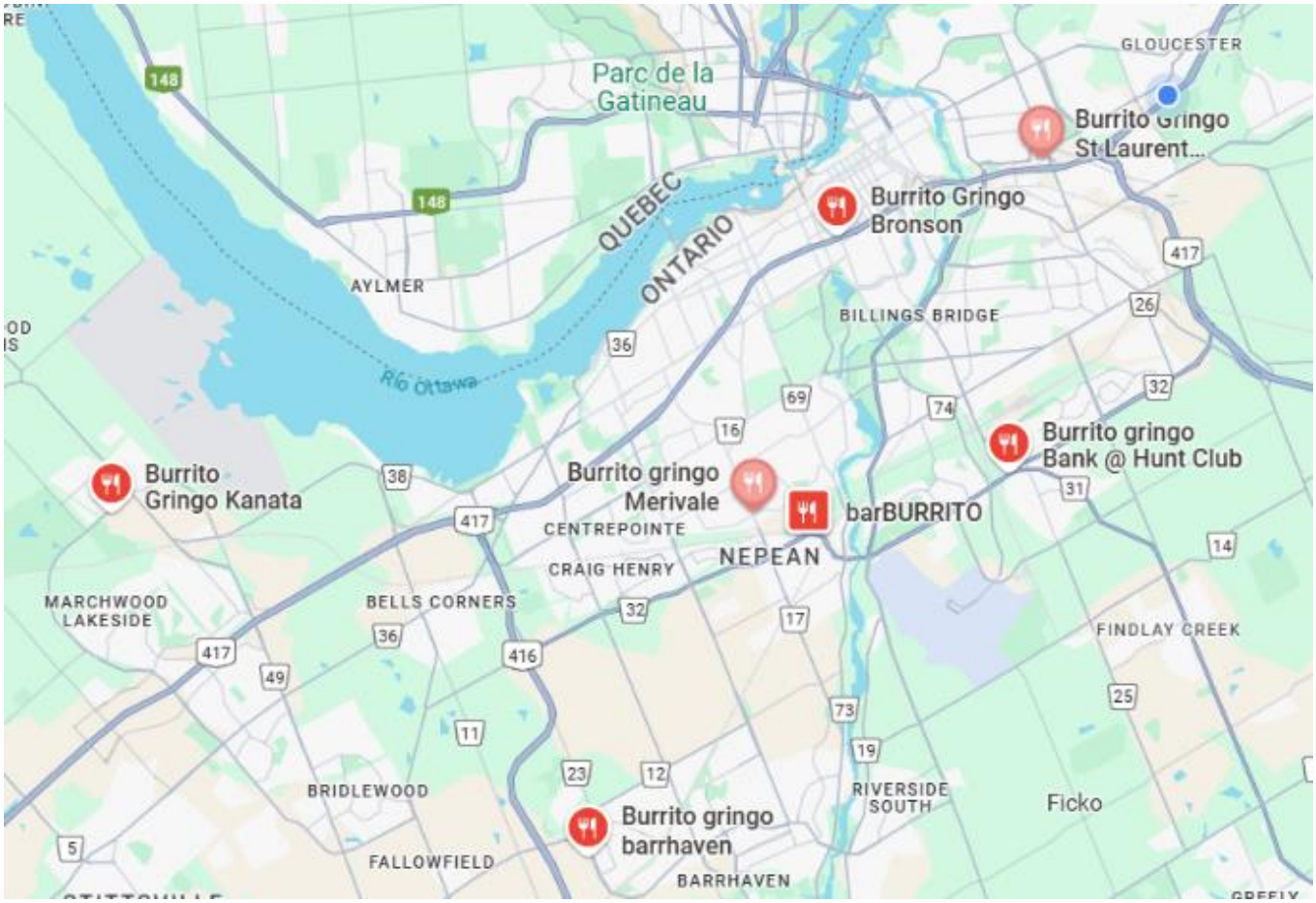
Company size:

Number of employees: Although exact figures on the total number of employees at Burrito Gringo are not available, it is estimated that each of its six branches in Ottawa has approximately 15 employees. This suggests a total of approximately 90 employees' company wide.

Annual Revenue: Burrito Gringo operates six branches in Ottawa. If each branch generates approximately $620,000 CAD per year, total annual revenue would be about $3,720,000 CAD. (Based on 2018 data, the average location in the restaurant industry in Canada generated more than $620,000 CAD in annual revenue. This is where we estimate it from)

Geographic presence:

Figure 1. Map of Burritos Gringos Location



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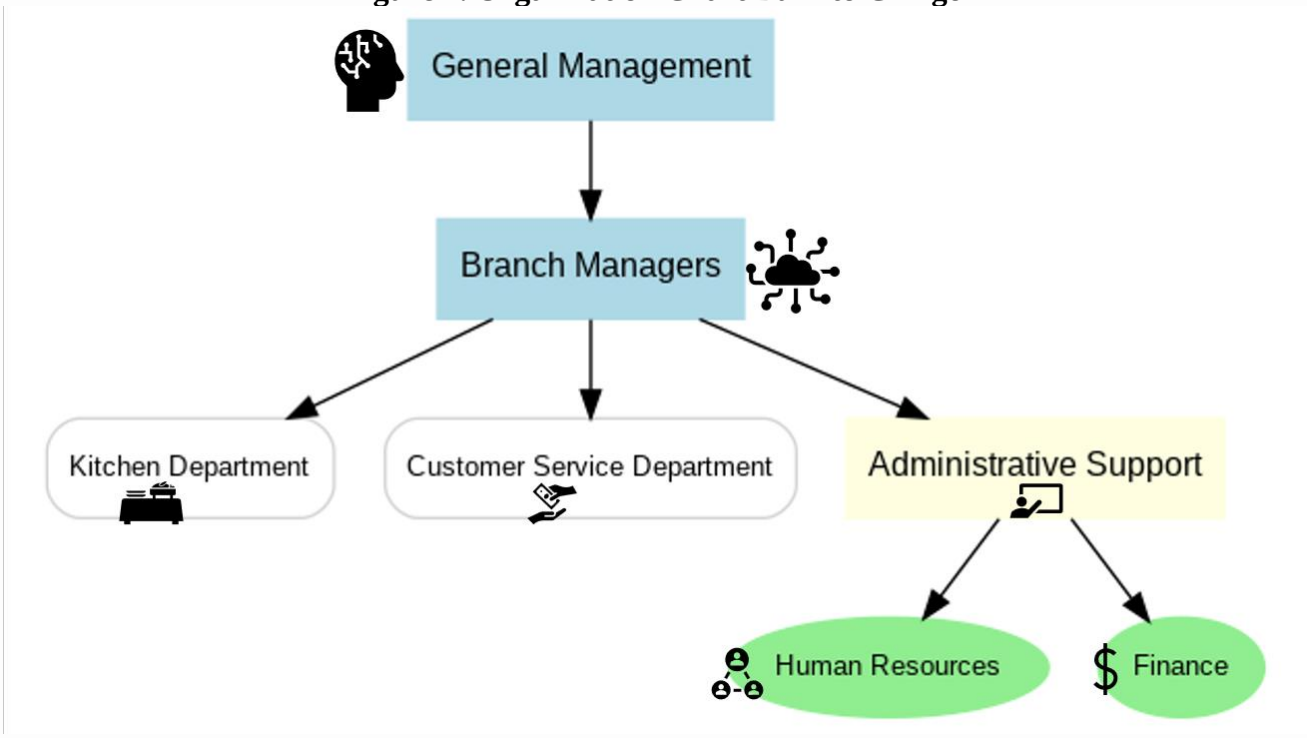
Organization chart, employee count, branches, locations.

Figure 2. Organization Chart Burrito Gringo



Source: created with original content based on the company's own information

Organizational chart: Hierarchical structure of the company, key roles and main departments.

General Management: Oversees all operations and strategy at the corporate level.

Branch Managers: Each location has a manager responsible for day-to-day supervision, including personnel management and operations.

Kitchen Department: Responsible for food preparation and cooking.

Customer Service Department: Personnel responsible for direct customer service and cashier area.

Administrative Support (Human Resources, Finance): Handles administrative functions such as hiring, training, and accounting.

Number of employees: Staff distribution by areas or departments.

Branch Manager: 1

Kitchen Team: 4-3 (includes cooks and kitchen assistants)

Customer Service Team: 6-7 (customer service, cashier, and cleaners).

With six branches, Burrito Gringo is estimated to have about 90 employees in total.

Locations and branches: Details of offices or points of operation and their geographical distribution.

1. Kanata North

2. Barrhaven

3. Bronson

4. Ottawa South

5. Ottawa East

6. Nepean

B) Business strategy

Business Motivation Model (BMM)

Goals: Achieve sustainable and orderly growth in the marketplace, improving customer experience and operational efficiency.

Strategies: Implementation of integrated management software to better organize operations, improve inventory control, manage online ordering, and optimize customer service.

Tactics: Adoption of digital tools for day-to-day branch administration, development of online sales capabilities, and partnership with home delivery platforms.

Guidelines: Maintain focus on quality of service, freshness of ingredients and authenticity of flavors, using technology to strengthen the value proposition.

- **Motivational factors**: Reasons behind digitization, such as improving efficiency, reducing costs or increasing competitiveness.

Burrito gringo has existed over a long time, and for it to say stable through the rough fast-food business it had to adapt, so, many few years back burrito gringo decided to start selling their products through the famous platforms Uber eats, DoorDash and Lyft, generating a new source of revenue and solving the problem that many business were experiencing, the digitalization, that's why they decided to step up with the integration of these platforms.

Operational Efficiency: Digitization enables more efficient management of resources, which is critical in a growing chain.

Cost Reduction: Management software can reduce errors in inventory and inventory management. In the Burrito Gringo case, it would be RestoSoft, an inventory and cashier system integrated to bring a solution to little businesses.

Increased Competitiveness: With technology, Burrito Gringo can better position itself against competitors by offering online options and expanding its reach to a greater number of customers.

Improved Customer Experience: Digitization facilitates a faster checkout process and home delivery options, which improves customer satisfaction.

Figure 3.- Business Motivation Model

BUSINESS MOTIVATION MODEL

MEANS

Mision

Burrito Gringo emphasizes a commitment to fresh, authentic Mexican food, crafted daily from local ingredients. The company strives to deliver quality by hand-preparing each meal, focusing on natural flavors and avoiding processed items, additives, or preservatives.

Strategy

Market differentiation through quality and authenticity:
Emphasize Burrito Gringo's unique selling points, fresh ingredients, authenticity, and handmade recipes.
Expansion in key locations:
Open new locations in high traffic to attract more local customers.
Digital and community-based marketing:
Use social media, local events, and partnerships with communities to create brand loyalty.

Policies

Freshness and Quality Policy
- All food ingredients must meet high standards of freshness and quality,

Sustainability Policy
- Commit to sustainable practices by minimizing food waste

Rules

Delivery and Order Accuracy Rules
- Online orders must be double-checked by staff before dispatch.

Food Preparation Rules
- All dishes must be prepared fresh daily,

ENDS

Vision

Aim to stand out from larger fast-food chains by maintaining high-quality standards while ensuring fast service for customers.

Desired Result

Visibility and inventory improvement
- Improve inventory and supply chain efficiency using real-time digital tools.
- Enhance marketing efforts with a focus on personalization and loyalty programs.

Expansion and Sustainability
- Expand locations while maintaining service quality and consistency.
- Lead sustainability efforts by reducing waste and adopting eco-friendly practices.

ASSESSMENT

Market Trends Assessment
Influencer: Growing consumer demand for fresh, fast, and customizable food options.
Risk: Risk of failing to differentiate from similar quick-service restaurants.

Technology Trends Assessment
Influencer: Rapid adoption of restaurant management tools like CRM and AI analytics.
Risk: Potential costs of software adoption can outweigh benefits.

Regulatory and Sustainability Assessment
Influencer: Pressure for eco-friendly practices and regulatory compliance.
Risk: Significant costs for adapting to new environmental regulations

INFLUENCER

Internal

Brand and Customer Relationships
- A reputation for fresh, high-quality food and personalized service.

Human Resources
- Skilled employees with expertise in preparing authentic Mexican cuisine.

Digital Infrastructure
- Basic technology to support operations

Operational Strengths
- Efficient processes for ingredient sourcing, preparation, and delivery.

External

Market Trends
- Growing demand for fresh, fast, and customizable food options.

Competition
- Presence of other quick-service restaurants offering Mexican cuisine or similar options.

Technological Trends
- Rapid advancements in restaurant management tools, including CRM, inventory systems, and AI.

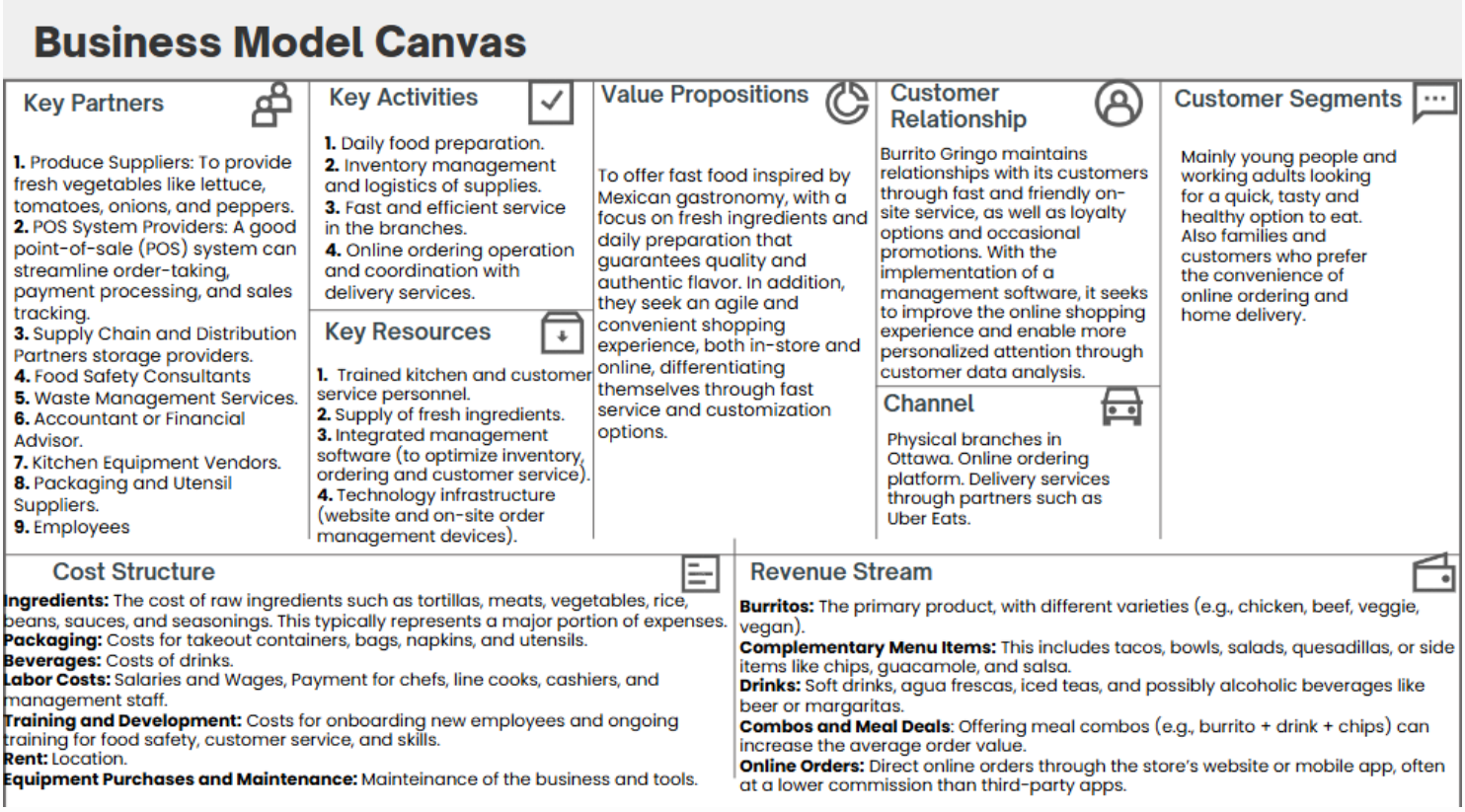
Regulatory and Legal Influences
- Compliance with food safety standards and employee labor laws.

Economic Environment
- Inflationary pressures affecting ingredient costs.

Canvas

The integration of management software will enable Burrito Gringo to optimize the operation of several of these blocks. For example, it will improve accuracy in inventory management, facilitate the organization of online ordering, and enable detailed tracking of customer preferences, helping to personalize the experience and implement loyalty strategies. In addition, the software will enable data consolidation, which is essential for analyzing and adapting to market behavior.

Figure 4. Business Model Cavas



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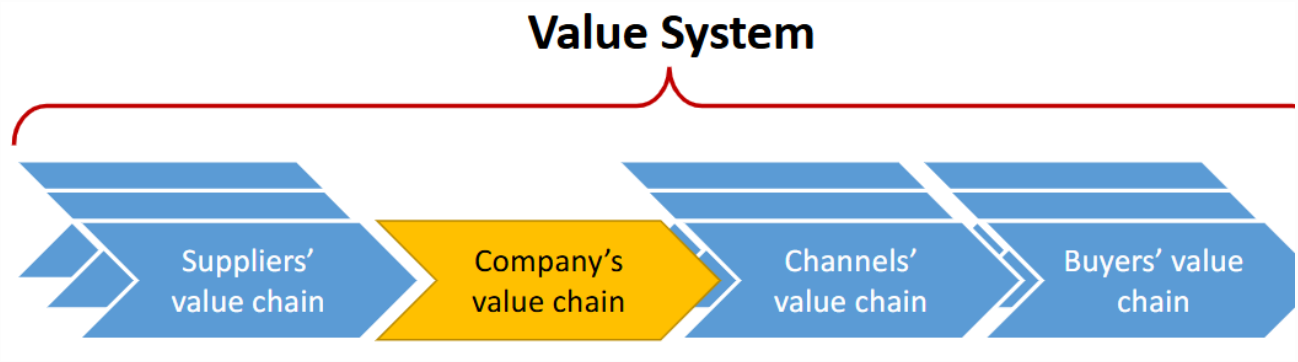
Value System Model

Figure 5. Value System



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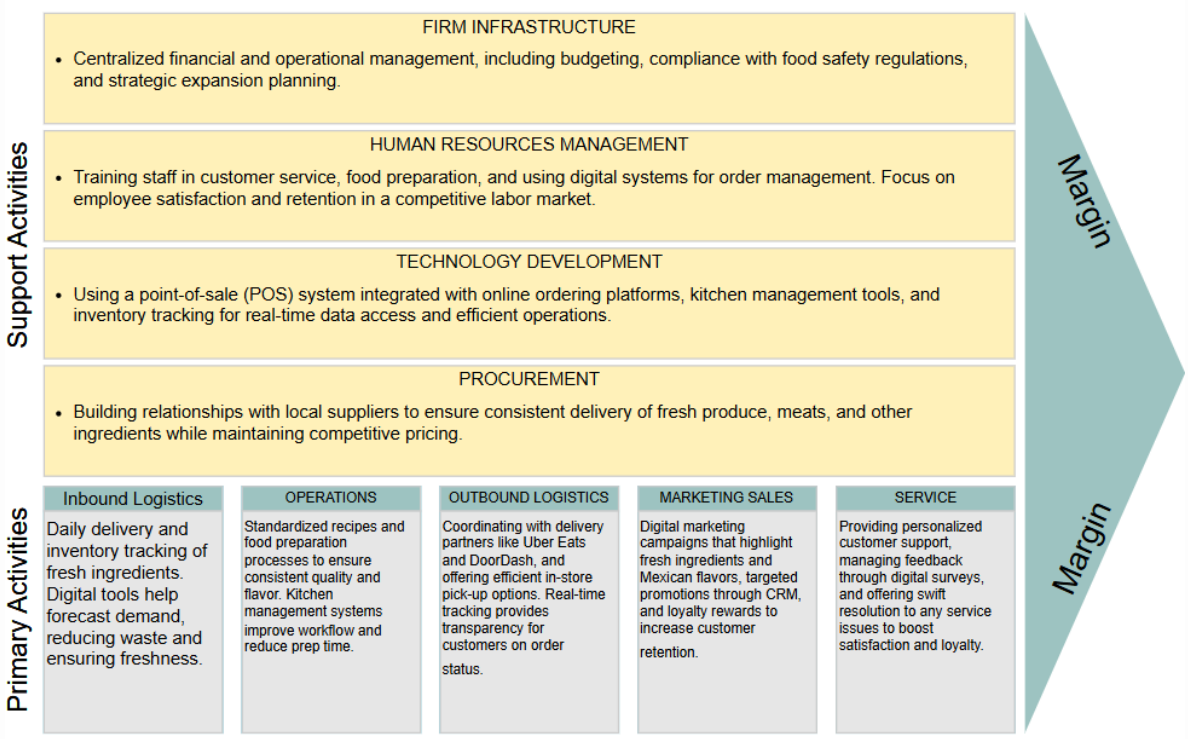
Suppliers' Value Chain

- Description: Suppliers provide Burrito Gringo with high-quality, fresh ingredients like vegetables, meats, tortillas, and spices.
- Key Aspects: Sourcing to Burrito Gringo high-quality standards, and timely delivery are crucial for maintaining freshness and quality.
- Digital Optimization: Using real-time inventory software to coordinate directly with suppliers, defining minimal stockouts and reducing waste.

Figure 6. Company´s Value Chain



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Margin: By effectively integrating these primary and support activities, Burrito Gringo improves its efficiency, reduces waste, and improves customer satisfaction. This generates a competitive advantage and supports profitability in the restaurant market. (Gabrani, 2024)

Channel's Value Chain

Description: Burrito Gringo's food reaches customers through various channels, including in-store food, online orders, and delivery services like Uber Eats and DoorDash.

Digital Optimization: Integration with delivery platforms with real-time order tracking to ensure efficiency and satisfaction of customers.

Buyers' Value Chain

Description: The final experience that customers have with Burrito Gringo's products, the quality of the food, and how they feel after they buy a product.

Key Aspects: Consistency in quality, speed, and accessibility to the physical store, as well as the ability to order from Uber or Doordash.

Digital Tools: Loyalty programs to encourage more purchases and online customer feedback.

Capability Analysis
Figure 7. Capability Analysis

CAPABILITY ANALYSIS

Restaurant Management

Vendor Management:
Vendor Information Management

- Vendor Information Addition

Document every new supplier and track their performance throughout the years.

- Vendor Information Update

Keep track of every supplier with a constant monthly update reunion.

- Vendor Information Deletion

Vendor Contact Management

- Vendor Contact Notification and Inquiry

Every notification and Inquiry is being processed and analyzed to ensure a proper information and planning, also, the vendors are notified every week to provide feedback and engagement on all suppliers.

Manage Product Acquisition

Product Information Management
Inventory Management:

- Track and record the inventory levels of all products.
- Implement automatic reordering systems based on preset inventory thresholds.

Product Request Management:
Internal Product Requests

- Facilitate the process for staff to request necessary products.
- Ensure communication channels between kitchen staff and manager as in Burrito gringo there is no Procurement Team.

External Product Orders

- Place orders with external suppliers for needed products.
- Manage the timeline and process for external product deliveries.

Product Fulfillment Management
Receiving Products

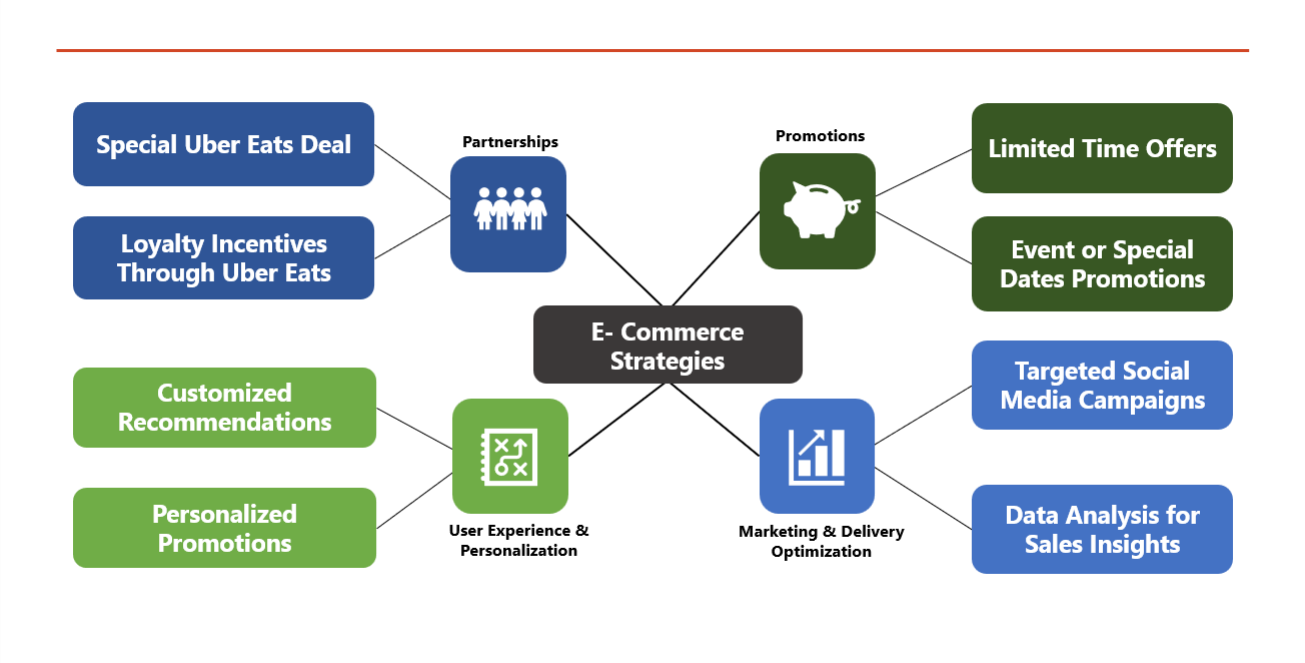
- Establish a protocol for receiving and inspecting products upon delivery to ensure they meet quality standards.
- Document and resolve any discrepancies with suppliers

Storage and Handling

- Storage ensures product freshness and safety.
- Proper training on all the procedures maintaining product integrity.

E-commerce Strategies

Figure 8.- Mind Map: Strategic Overview of Burrito Gringo



Source: created with original content based on the company's own information

Burrito Gringo already leverages a B2C (Business to Consumer) e-commerce model through platforms like Uber Eats, providing a strong foundation for engaging directly with end consumers. However, there is an opportunity to expand this approach by implementing personalized strategies and dynamic promotions to further strengthen customer relationships. By enhancing their use of digital tools, Burrito Gringo could introduce exclusive deals, loyalty programs, and targeted promotions tailored to customer preferences. Additionally, a greater focus on user experience optimization and digital marketing efforts could help maximize customer satisfaction, boost retention, and drive sustained sales growth. These enhancements could position the company as a leader in its niche while capitalizing on its existing digital presence.

Partnerships

1. Special Uber Eats Deal
    a. Description: Offer a special menu item at a discount, with the specific dish and discount changing based on the day of the week.
    b. Goal: This approach encourages customers to check your Uber Eats page regularly to see which item is on special, helping drive consistent traffic and orders.
    c. Example: "*Taco Tuesday*" where tacos are 20% off every Tuesday, or "*Mexican Burrito Friday*" with a special discount on it.

2. Loyalty Incentives Through Uber Eats
    a. Description: Implement a reward for loyal customers who order frequently from your restaurant on Uber Eats.
    b. Goal: This strategy builds customer loyalty, encouraging repeat orders and making customers feel appreciated, which can lead to long term brand loyalty.

c. Example: After a customer place their 5th order, they receive a surprise gift with their next order, such as a free dessert or drink.

Promotions

1. Limited Time Offers

   a. Description: Create time-sensitive discounts or deals that are only available for a short period.
   b. Goal: Limited time offers create a sense of urgency, encouraging customers to place orders quickly to take advantage of the deal. This can help increase sales during specific times or days when business might be slower.
   c. Example: Offer a 15% discount on all orders during lunch hours e.g., 11 a.m. to 2 p.m., or provide free delivery on weekends.

2. **Event or Special Dates Promotions**

   a. Description: Set up special promotions during holidays or local events to attract more customers.
   b. Goal: These promotions allow your restaurant to capitalize on high-demand days, attracting customers who are celebrating or participating in events, and encouraging them to order from your restaurant on Uber Eats.
   c. Example: Offer a "Valentine's Day Special" where customers receive a free dessert with any main course or create a "Game Day Burrito Combo" during sports events.

User Experience & Personalization

1. Customized Recommendations

   a. Description: Use Uber Eats' data to offer personalized recommendations based on a customer's previous orders.
   b. Goal: Customized recommendations make it easier for customers to discover items they're likely to enjoy, enhancing their ordering experience and encouraging repeat orders.
   c. Example: If a customer frequently orders tacos, your restaurant could highlight new or popular taco options, like specialty tacos or new burrito flavors.

2.- Personalized Promotions

   - Description: Provide targeted discounts or special offers based on individual customer behavior or preferences.
   - Goal: Personalized promotions make customers feel valued and recognized, increasing customer satisfaction and loyalty by catering to their preferences.
   - Example: Offer a small discount on a customer's favorite item or a "welcome back" deal for customers who haven't ordered in a while.

Marketing & Delivery Optimization

1. Targeted Social Media Campaigns

    a. Description: Promote your restaurant's presence on Uber Eats through social media ads, targeting local customers who prefer delivery.
    b. Goal: Social media campaigns help increase visibility for your restaurant on Uber Eats, attracting more orders by reaching a broader audience.
    c. Example: Run ads on Instagram and Facebook highlighting your taco and burrito offerings, with a direct link to your Uber Eats page. You could feature customer favorites, special offers, or limited-time deals.

2. Data Analysis for Sales Insights

    a. Description: Use Uber Eats' order data to analyze sales trends, popular items, and peak order times.
    b. Goal: By understanding customer preferences and order patterns, you can make data-driven decisions to optimize your menu, improve customer satisfaction, and boost revenue.
    c. Example: Track which types of tacos or burritos sell the most and during what times of day. Use this information to adjust your menu or create promotions to drive even more sales.

Operations Process identification

Top-level processes identification and description

Strategic processes

- Strategic development: Setting the restaurant's long-term goals, assessing competitive positioning, and planning for growth. It includes analyzing trends in the fast-service industry, identifying potential market opportunities, and developing strategies to enhance brand presence and profitability.
- Develop new products: Create new menu items that align with customer preferences and food trends. It involves research and development (R&D) to test flavors, ingredients, and recipes while ensuring consistency, quality, and alignment with the brand's identity.
- Franchise Management: Ensuring consistent communication with the franchisor by regularly providing updates on key performance metrics such as sales, customer satisfaction, and operational efficiency. This helps maintain alignment with brand standards, identify areas for improvement, and receive ongoing guidance and support to optimize performance and uphold the integrity of the franchise.
- Brand Management and Marketing Strategy: Developing advertising campaigns, promotions, and brand positioning to increase brand awareness and attract customers.

Operational processes

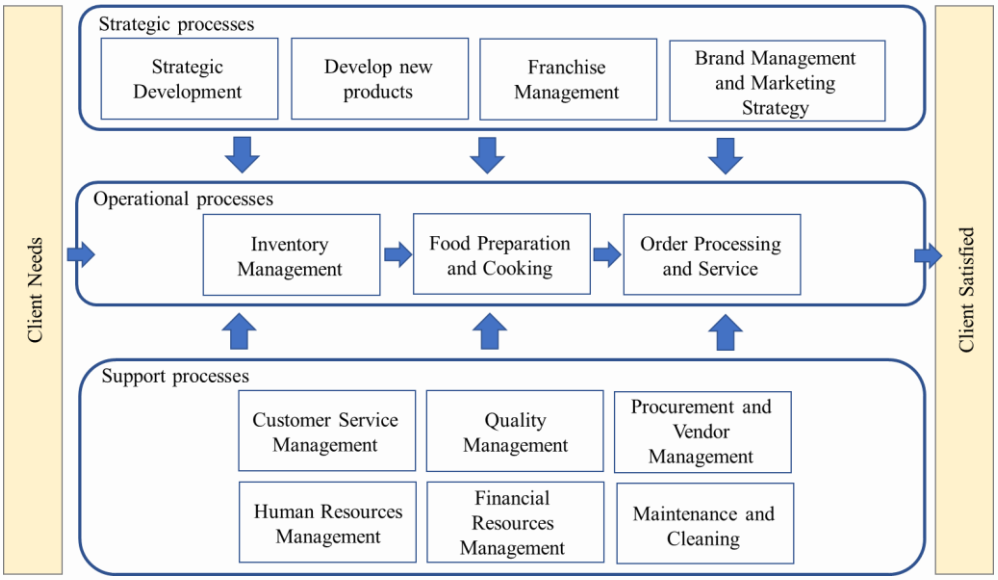
- Inventory Management: Ensuring a reliable flow of ingredients, packaging, and other materials needed for daily operations.
- Food Preparation and Cooking: Preparing and cooking menu items according to standardized procedures for consistency and quality.
- Order Processing and Service: Taking customer orders, handling payments, and delivering food promptly (counter, or online ordering).

Support Processes

- Customer Service Management: Managing and improving the interaction between a company and its customers to ensure satisfaction, loyalty, and effective problem-solving. It involves various activities to address customer needs, resolve issues, and enhance the overall customer experience.
- Human Resources Management: Recruiting, training, and retaining employees, focusing on customer service and operational consistency.
- Financial Resources Management: Managing the restaurant's budget, making sure there's enough money to cover costs, and finding ways to save or invest in improvements.
- Quality Management: Ensuring that food and service are consistently good by checking that ingredients are fresh, food is cooked properly, and customers are satisfied. This also includes making sure that health and safety standards are followed.
- Procurement and Vendor Management: Sourcing materials and equipment, managing vendor relationships, and negotiating contracts.
- Maintenance and Cleaning: Ensuring equipment, kitchens, and dining areas are well-maintained and compliant with safety standards.

Note: The company does not have an internal support system, as this process is included within the software service they have acquired.

Figure 9. Process Mapping Burrito Gringo



Source: created with company's own information.

Management information systems needed per process

Based on the process map, the current Management Information Systems (MIS) in use have been identified. The following table outlines the systems, including their names, objectives, and their current state (implemented or not implemented). This analysis provides a clear overview of how each system supports key operational processes and highlights potential areas for further improvement or adoption.

Table 1. Management Information Systems are required for each process.

	Process	MIS	Software Name	Objective/ Function of the System	Actual State
Strategic Processes	Strategic Development	Business Intelligence (BI) Tools	N/A	To analyze market trends, competitive positioning, and growth opportunities. Provides insights for decision-making and strategy development.	Not Implemented/Basic Analytics in Excel
	Develop New Products	Product Development Software (R&D Management Tools)	N/A	To manage the research and development of new products, including testing, feedback, and recipe optimization.	Not Implemented/ Basic or Manual Process
	Franchise Management	Franchise Management Software	N/A	To track franchisee performance, manage communication with the franchisor, and ensure brand alignment and operational consistency.	Not Implemented/Basic Communication

	Brand Management and Marketing Strategy	Marketing Automation Tools	Google Analytics	To create and manage marketing campaigns, track brand performance, and analyze customer engagement.	Currently, e-commerce tracking is being analyzed on platforms like Uber Eats, and its implementation in digital marketing processes is underway.
Operational processes	Inventory Management	Inventory Management System (IMS)	Restaurante 365	To track stock levels, manage orders, prevent waste, and streamline inventory processes.	Implemented (Basic Stock Management)
	Food Preparation and Cooking	Kitchen Display Systems (KDS)	N/A	To facilitate communication between the kitchen and front-of-house staff, ensuring restocking is completed in a timely and accurate manner	Not Implemented
	Order Processing and Service	Point of Sale (POS)	Restaurante 365	To handle customer orders, payments, and sales tracking in real-time, both in-store and through online ordering.	Implemented
Support processes	Customer Service Management	Customer Relationship Management (CRM)	N/A	Manage customer interactions, track feedback, and resolve issues, ensuring customer satisfaction and loyalty.	Not Implemented
	Human Resources Management	Human Resources Management Systems	QuickBooks	To manage employee recruitment, training, performance, payroll, and retention efforts.	Basic System. Training performance is not Implemented
	Financial Resources Management	Accounting Software	QuickBooks	To manage budgets, expenses, financial reports, and profitability analysis. Helps make informed financial decisions and track cash flow.	Implemented
	Quality Management	Quality Management Systems (QMS)	N/A	To monitor food safety standards, ingredient quality, and service consistency. Ensures compliance with health and safety regulations.	Not Implemented
	Procurement and Vendor Management	Procurement Software	QuickBooks	Manage supplier relationships, track purchase orders, and handle contract negotiations to maintain consistent supply.	Implemented
	Maintenance and Cleaning	Facility Management Software	N/A	To schedule maintenance tasks, track equipment issues, and ensure cleanliness and safety standards are upheld throughout the restaurant.	Not Implemented/Manual Tracking

Source: Created by the company's own information.

Database design

Table 2. Entities Identification

Entities	Attributes	Business connection
Restaurant	Restaurant_ID, Name, Location, Contact_Info, Order Id and Revenue.	Responsible for managing employees, offering menu items, handling orders, and implementing marketing campaigns.
Menu Item	ItemID, Name, Menu_ID, Price, Ingredients, Preparation_Time, Employee_Id	Included in orders, sourced through inventory, and managed by employees.
Customer	Customer_ID, Name, Contact_Info,Payment_Method	Places Order and Provides Customer Feedback.
Order	Order_ID,Order_Date,Total_Amount, Payment_Status, Customer_id, Menu Id	Placed by Customer, Includes Menu Item, Handled by Restaurant employee.
Inventory	Inventory_ID,Item_Name,Quantity,Supplier_ID Restock_Level	Managed by Procurement is Supplied by Vendor and sourced is from Menu Item.
Vendor	Supplier_ID, Name, Contact_Info, Product_List, Procument_id	Supplies Procurement
Employee	Employee_ID, Name,Position, Hire_Date, Salary	Works for Restaurant.
Financial Account	Account_ID,Budget,Expenses,Revenue, Profit_Margin,	Supports Restaurant
Customer Feedback	Feedback_ID, Customer_ID, Comments, Rating, Submision_Date,	Provided by Customer, Reviewed by Restaurant
Procurement	Procurement_ID,Supplier_ID,Order_Date, CostDelivery_Status	Interfaces with Vendor, Manages Inventory
Marketing Campaign	Feedback_id, Campaign_ID, Start_date, End_date, Budget, Target audience.	Implements changes based on customer feedback and available budget.

Source: Created by the company's own information.

Entity relationship diagram

Figure 10. Entity relationship diagram

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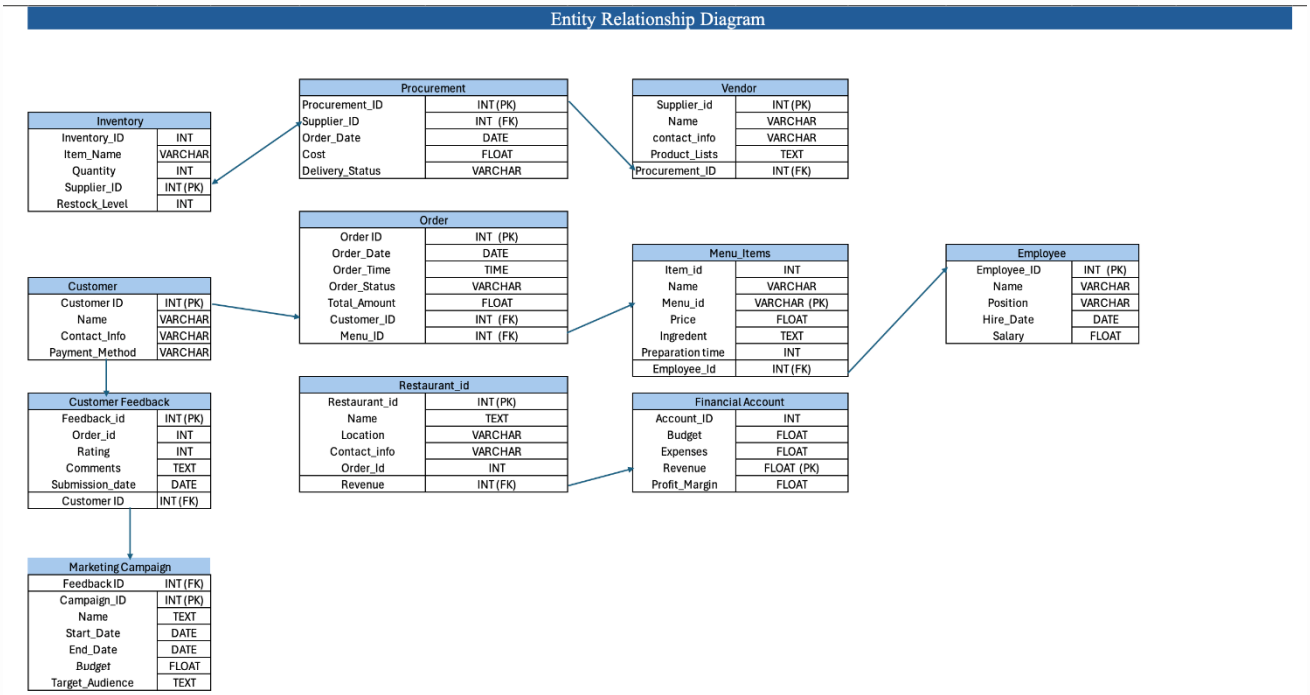


Source: Created by the company's own information.

The ERD represents relationships among key entities in a restaurant's operations, including:

1. **Restaurant:** Central entity.
2. **Menu Item**: Details offered items, linked to orders.
3. **Customers:** Connects to orders and feedback.
4. **Order:** Core transaction entity.
5. **Inventory & Vendor:** Manage stock and procurement.
6. **Employee**: Staff details.
7. **Marketing Campaign:** Promotions tracking.
8. **Financial Account:** Revenue/expense records.
9. **Customer Feedback:** Quality input.

This diagram supports comprehensive management and process integration.

Management Information Systems

Platform

Including the currently platform used (**Restaurant365**), four platforms have been chosen for analysis:

i. **Restaurant365** is an all-in-one, cloud-based restaurant management platform that includes accounting, inventory management, and scheduling software. The platform integrates directly with over 70 POS systems and supports direct vendor integration. Priced at $469 per month per location (billed quarterly), it allows unlimited users and provides sharing capabilities with accountants, who can log in to the same system and automate reports. Managers can set specific user roles and permissions. The platform is scalable, accommodating multiple locations and offering add-ons like payroll and HR software. Key products include Budgeting and Forecasting, Financial Reporting, Inventory Management, Cash Management, Scheduling, Employee Training, Task Management and Payroll.

ii. **Upserve** by Lightspeed offers a customizable restaurant POS system tailored to unique workflows, including menus, screens, and floor plans. It enhances guest experiences with seamless ordering and data-backed recommendations. The platform provides real-time insights with every transaction, allowing the managers to compare sales data by hour, day, week, or month, and understand revenue sources to focus your efforts effectively. It helps optimize pricing strategies by comparing food and drink prices against the local market and identifying peak hours to optimize staffing and reduce labor costs. Upserve also anticipates changes in demand, aiding in inventory and staffing planning. The platform supports multiple locations and partner API access, compatible with iOS and Android. Key products include Payment Processing for seamless transactions, Inventory Management to track ingredients, Accounting to automate bookkeeping, and Payroll & Workforce Management for scheduling, labor forecasting, and tip management. Equip employees with lightweight handheld POS devices to speed up orders and payments.

iii. **Toast** is a cloud-based, all-in-one digital technology platform purpose-built for restaurants. It offers a comprehensive suite of software as a service (SaaS) products and financial technology solutions, covering point of sale, operations, digital ordering and delivery, marketing, payroll, HR, Inventory Management and Multi-location Management. Toast supports various service models, including dine-in, takeout, delivery, catering, and retail. Recognized for its innovation and impact, Toast was ranked fifth on the Forbes 2021 Cloud 100.

iv. **TouchBistro** is an all-in-one restaurant management platform that provides comprehensive insights into customer behavior and spending patterns, helping the restaurant make informed decisions to drive profit. It provides detailed reports to monitor staff performance and make informed scheduling, promotion, seasonal hiring, and training decisions. The platform offers over 50 reports that provide deep insights into sales trends, staff performance, and more, allowing the managers to make business decisions faster. Daily

sales reports can be automatically emailed to key team members, and export options and integrations enable seamless sharing of sales data. Includes Inventory management tools to help reduce food waste and theft, while labor forecasting tools ensure your venue is always adequately staffed. Key products include Point of Sale, Reporting & Analytics, Payment Processing, Staff Management, Guest Engagement, Inventory Management, Labor Management, Kitchen Display System, and Profit Management.

1.1.1. Selection Criteria

The selection criteria are based upon the suggestions made by Iana (2017) and Kurzina (2017) but includes a personalized criteria based on the project's business objectives.

All the criteria defined for the evaluation in platform selection hold the same level of relevance, as each plays a fundamental role in aligning the system with the restaurant's operational needs. To assess the degree to which each software meets these criteria, a scale from 1 to 5 will be used, where 1 represents the lowest level of compliance and 5 indicates the highest.

Table 3: Selection criteria Platform

Selection Criteria	Relation to Burrito gringo Digital Transformation
Support for Portable Devices	Evaluates whether the software supports mobile devices such as tablets and smartphones, enhancing efficiency in order taking, inventory management, and real-time data access.
User Interface	Refers to the design and layout of the software, focusing on ease of use and intuitiveness, reducing training time, minimizing errors, and improving user satisfaction.
Streamlining Processes	Involves the software's ability to simplify and automate routine tasks, reducing manual effort and increasing efficiency, leading to faster service and improved customer satisfaction.
Process Automation	Refers to the software's capability to automate repetitive tasks such as scheduling, payroll, and inventory updates, reducing human error, saving time, and allowing staff to focus on strategic activities.
Optimize Data Management (Sales & Inventory)	Assesses the software's ability to manage and optimize sales and inventory data, ensuring accurate tracking and informed decisions about stock replenishment and sales strategies.
Processes Standardization	Involves creating uniform procedures across all branches, ensuring consistency in service quality and operational efficiency, making it easier to manage multiple locations and maintain brand standards.
Analytical Functions (Big Data, Visualization, Forecasting)	Includes the ability to analyze large datasets, visualize data through charts and graphs, and forecast future trends, helping in understanding customer behavior, predicting demand, and making data-driven decisions.
Flexibility	Refers to the software's ability to adapt to changing business needs, including customizable features, scalability to accommodate growth, and integration with other systems.
Implementation Time	Evaluates the time required to implement the software, with faster implementation leading to quicker benefits realization, less disruption to operations, and a faster return on investment.

Total Cost of Ownership vs Total Usage Cost	Compares the initial purchase cost with ongoing operational costs, including expenses for software licenses, hardware, maintenance, and support services, to understand the long-term financial impact.
Payment Options	Refers to the flexibility in payment plans offered by the software provider, including one-time payments, subscription models, or pay-as-you-go options, helping manage cash flow and budget constraints.

Source: Created by the company's own information.

Main advantages

Table 4. Main Advantages Platform

Software \ Criteria	Restaurante365 (Currently)	Upserve by Lightspeed	Toast	TouchBistro
Support for Portable Devices	No mobile support	Yes, compatible with iOS and Android	Yes, mobile app for iOS and Android	Yes, mobile app for iOS
	1	5	5	5
User Interface	Good, comprehensive interface	Excellent, highly intuitive interface	Excellent, intuitive interface	Excellent, intuitive, and easy to use
	4	5	5	5
Streamlining Processes	Good, integrates accounting, inventory, and scheduling	Excellent, integrates all restaurant operations	Excellent, integrates front and back-office operations	Good, integrates front-of-house operations
	4	5	5	4
Process Automation	Good, automates financial reporting and payroll	Excellent, advanced automation features	Excellent, automates inventory tracking and order processing	Good, basic automation features
	4	5	5	4
Optimize Data (Sales & Inventory) Management	Excellent, advanced data management and reporting	Excellent, detailed sales and inventory analytics	Good, detailed sales and inventory reports	Good, essential sales and inventory reports
	5	5	4	4
Processes Standardization	Excellent, standardizes financial and inventory processes	Excellent, standardizes processes and training	Good, standardizes recipes and order processes	Good, standardizes menu and order processes
	5	5	4	4

Analytical Functions (Big Data, Visualization, Forecasting)	Excellent, robust analytics and forecasting capabilities	Excellent, comprehensive analytics and forecasting tools	Good, offers sales forecasting and customer insights	Good, basic analytics and reporting tools
	5	5	4	4
Flexibility	Good, flexible but less modular	Excellent, highly adaptable and scalable	Excellent, modular and scalable	Good, flexible with various modules
	4	5	5	4
Implementation Time	Moderate setup time	Moderate setup time	Quick, minimal downtime	Quick, minimal disruption
	3	3	5	5
Total Cost of Ownership vs Total Usage Cost	Moderate, higher initial cost, moderate ongoing costs	Good, balanced cost structure	Good, balanced initial and ongoing costs	Good, balanced cost structure
	3	4	4	4
Payment Options	Moderate, standard payment plans	Flexible, monthly subscriptions and pay-as-you-go options	Flexible, monthly subscriptions and pay-as-you-go options	Flexible, monthly subscriptions and pay-as-you-go options
	3	5	5	5

Source: Created by the company's own information.

After reviewing the selection criteria, Upserve by Lightspeed is selected as the software given it offers a robust, flexible, and comprehensive solution that aligns well with the operational needs and growth ambitions of Burrito Gringo. Its focus on enhancing sales, providing real-time insights, and optimizing both inventory and staffing makes it an ideal choice for ensuring efficient and profitable restaurant operations. The following list details Upsever's benefits.

- **Comprehensive Customization:** Upserve by Lightspeed allows for extensive customization of the restaurant POS system to fit unique workflows, including menus, screens, and floor plans. This flexibility ensures that the system can be tailored specifically to Burrito Gringo's operational needs.
- **Real-Time Insights:** Upserve provides real-time insights with every integrated transaction, allowing Burrito Gringo to instantly know what actions to take next. This feature is invaluable for making informed decisions quickly and effectively.
- **Detailed Analytics:** the software offers detailed analytics, enabling the comparison of sales data by hour, day, week, or month. It helps understand revenue sources, optimize pricing strategies, and identify peak hours to optimize staffing and reduce labor costs. These insights are essential for maximizing profitability and operational efficiency.

- **Inventory and Staffing Management:** Upserve's inventory management tracks ingredients at a granular level, reducing waste and ensuring efficient stock management. The platform also includes labor forecasting tools to anticipate changes in demand, helping to plan inventory and staffing effectively.
- **Multi-Location Support: f**or a growing business-like Burrito Gringo, Upserve supports multiple locations and provides partner API access, making it easier to manage all locations or revenue centers from one platform.
- **Compatibility and Integration:** Upserve is compatible with both iOS and Android operating systems, ensuring that it can be used on a variety of devices. It also integrates seamlessly with other business solutions, enhancing overall operational efficiency.

Modules identification

Table 5. Modules Identification

Modules Upserve by Lightspeed	Description	Main Features
Payment Processing	Facilitates the secure processing of customer payments. It supports various payment methods, including credit and debit cards, mobile wallets, gift cards, and contactless payments. By integrating with POS (Point of Sale) systems, it ensures seamless transactions, reduces human error, and speeds up the checkout process.	• Secure transaction encryption. • Multi-payment method support (cards, digital wallets). • Integration with POS and third-party payment gateways. • Receipt generation and transaction history tracking.
Inventory Management	Helps track and manage ingredients, supplies, and stock levels in real time. It assists in monitoring inventory turnover, identifying trends in ingredient usage, and providing alerts for low stock levels. This helps ensure the restaurant never runs out of critical ingredients and minimizes food waste.	• Real-time inventory tracking. • Automated low-stock alerts. • Inventory reporting and analytics. • Integration with suppliers for reorder management. • Recipe costing and portion control tracking.
Accounting	Allows seamless integration of sales data from the restaurant's POS system with external accounting software, such as QuickBooks, Xero, or Sage. This module helps simplify financial management by automatically transferring accurate sales data, reducing manual data entry, and minimizing errors. It provides daily sales summaries, giving restaurant managers a clear view of their business	• Integration with popular accounting software (e.g., QuickBooks, Xero, Sage). • Automatic synchronization of sales data from POS to accounting software. • Cloud-based system for stability and secure access to financial data. • Daily automated sales summaries that align with business workflows.

	performance. The cloud-based system ensures data stability and secure access, allowing for real-time synchronization and monitoring of financial data.	• Reduced risk of data errors through the elimination of manual data entry.
Delivery	Consolidating orders from multiple third-party platforms, such as UberEats, Skip the Dishes, or DoorDash, into a single screen, streamlining the order management process. It offers tools to engage customers through promotions, track delivery performance, and expand delivery zones to reach more customers.	• Consolidation of online orders from multiple platforms (e.g., UberEats, Skip the Dishes, DoorDash) into a single POS system. • Customer engagement tools, such as discounts, promotions, and promo codes. • Ability to use customer data to retain regulars and improve delivery experiences. • Reporting tools to track performance, identify new opportunities, and optimize delivery zones.
Kitchen Display System	This module enables kitchen staff to easily track orders by status or order type, ensuring smooth and efficient operations. By displaying real-time updates on what needs to be prepared, when, and how, the KDS improves coordination across kitchen stations. It allows for the creation of pass, expedite, production, and delivery stations, further streamlining the workflow. Additionally, the system helps reduce food waste, lower costs, and improve staff efficiency, contributing to a more sustainable and cost-effective kitchen environment.	• Real-time tracking of orders by status or order type. • Ability to create pass, expedite, production, and delivery stations within the kitchen. • Status updates on individual dishes or entire tickets. • Optimized order accuracy and reduced turnaround times. • Improved sustainability by reducing food waste and increasing efficiency. • Cost-saving features that enhance kitchen performance.
Customer Facing Display	Is a screen that displays the order summary and total price to the customer during the checkout process. It enhances transparency, provides customers with a clear view of their order, and improves the overall customer experience.	• Order summary display (items, quantities, prices). • Payment confirmation and tip suggestions. • Customizable layout and branding options. • Integration with POS and payment systems.
PayRoll & WorkForce Managment	It allows flexible payroll runs and automates tip calculations for tipped employees. With features for employee onboarding, time clock, and attendance management, it reduces administrative tasks. The module also simplifies scheduling by forecasting sales and labor needs, optimizing staffing, and allowing employees to update availability and swap shifts remotely.	• Flexible payroll system with unlimited payroll runs. • Automated tip credit calculations for tipped employees. • Onboarding tools, including mobile access to paystubs and documents. • Sales and labor forecasting for accurate scheduling. • Remote shift management and employee shift reminders.

Source: Created by the company's own information.

Selection criteria modules

The selection of modules for the restaurant's information system will be based on the following criteria: relevance to restaurant operations, ease of integration with other systems, scalability to accommodate growth, cost-effectiveness, usability for staff, and impact on decision-making. Each criterion holds the same level of importance. Will be evaluated and rated on a scale of 1 to 5, with 5 representing the highest level of compliance or suitability for the restaurant's needs.

Table 6. Selection Criteria Modules

Selection Criteria	Description
Relevance for restaurant operations	This criterion assesses how well a module addresses critical needs specific to the restaurant's day-to-day operations. For example, does it help improve service speed, maintain inventory accuracy, or enhance customer loyalty? Modules that directly impact the restaurant's core functions, such as managing orders or tracking ingredients, would score higher.
Scalability	This criterion looks at whether the module can grow with the restaurant. For instance, as the restaurant expands to multiple locations or experiences higher customer demand, will the module be able to handle the increased load without needing a major overhaul? A scalable module will continue to serve the restaurant as it grows.
Cost effectiveness	Cost-effectiveness considers whether the value provided by the module justifies its price. This includes not just the initial investment, but also any ongoing costs like subscriptions or maintenance. A module that delivers a strong return on investment (ROI), such as reducing labor costs or increasing efficiency, would be deemed cost-effective.
Usability	Usability refers to how easy it is for restaurant staff to learn and operate the module. A user-friendly interface, clear instructions, and minimal training requirements make a module more attractive to implement. Modules that require less time to master are ideal for ensuring smooth day-to-day operations and minimizing errors.
Impact on Decision making	This criterion evaluates how well the module provides data and insights that support better business decisions. For example, does the module help identify trends in sales, monitor staff performance, or optimize inventory levels? Modules that deliver actionable insights enable restaurant managers to make informed decisions that improve efficiency, profitability, and customer satisfaction.

Source: Created by the company's own information.

Table 7. Module Criteria

Module \ Criteria	Relevance for restaurant operations	Scalability	Cost effectiveness	Usability	Impact on Decision making
Payment Processing	Vital for daily operations.	It can easily handle an increase in transaction volume, making it ideal as the business grows.	Including in the basic modules POS systems	Designed to be simple to use, reducing the risk of human error and speeding up transaction times.	Provides essential data, such as sales trends and payment method preferences, which can help the restaurant make decisions.
	5	5	5	5	5
Inventory Management	Crucial for managing stock, reducing waste, and ensuring ingredient availability.	Can grow with the restaurant, handling more items and locations.	Basic Inventory Management is Included in the basic modules of POS systems	It offers intuitive features minimizing human error and ensures inventory is properly managed without requiring significant manual input.	Provides insights and alerts in real-time.
	5	5	5	5	5
Accounting	Necessary for financial tracking and reporting.	Can handle increasing financial data and transactions as the business grows.	Included as part of a package, the cost is justified by its ability to reduce human errors and enhance decision-making value.	It may require some setup but generally automates most financial processes, making it easier to manage accounting tasks.	Provides sales analysis, allowing making informed decisions.
	5	5	5	4	5
Delivery	Vital for daily operations.	Can scale by increasing the number of delivery platforms it uses and managing more orders as the customer base grows.	Included as part of a package, the cost is justified by the optimization in the visualization and operation with deliveries.	Consolidate orders into a single interface. It is designed to be user-friendly, making it easy for staff to process orders, track deliveries,	The module provides valuable insights into delivery performance, customer preferences, and profit margins on

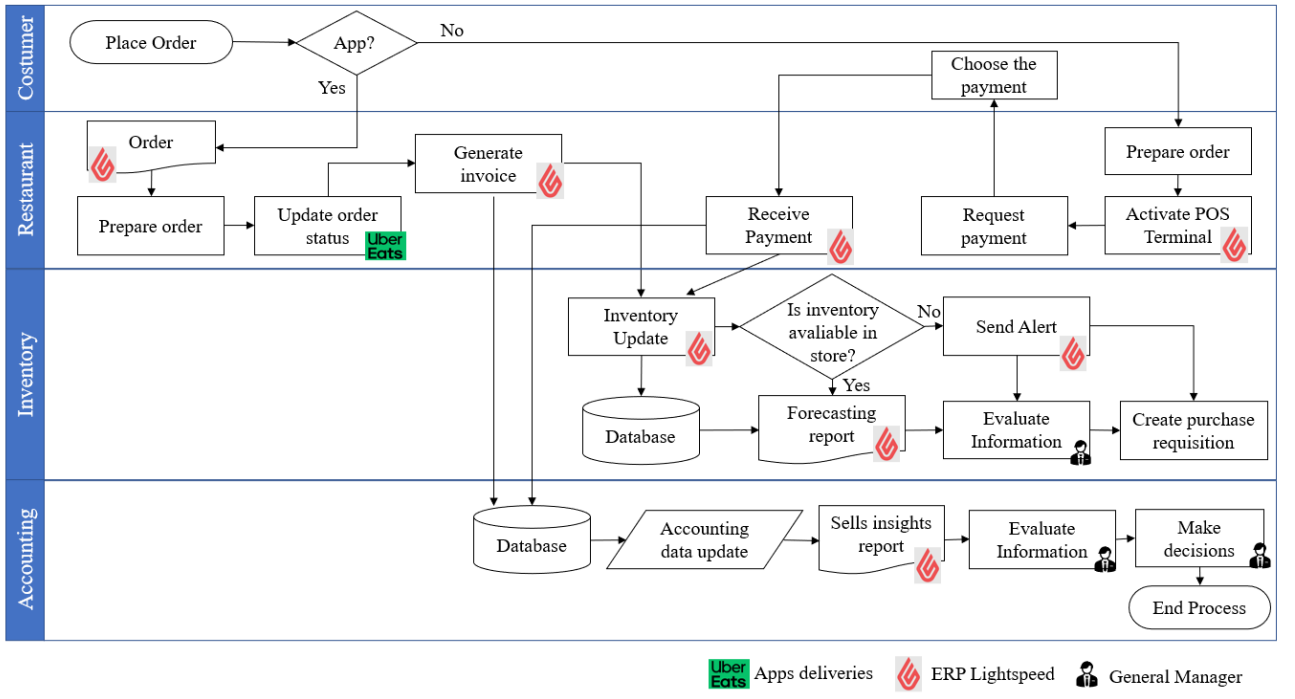
				and manage customer expectations.	delivery items.
	5	5	4	5	5
Kitchen Display System	It helps streamline kitchen operations by improving communication between front-of-house and kitchen staff avoiding delays in the middle of the service when supplies are running down.	Can scale with the kitchen restaurant's growth.	Included as part of a package, the cost is justified by its ability to increase productivity levels	It's highly intuitive, reducing the learning curve for kitchen staff.	Provides real-time data on order status, preparation time, and kitchen performance. This data can be used to improve kitchen efficiency,
	4	5	3	4	5
Customer Facing Display	Helps improve customer interaction and order accuracy	It can handle more customers or larger menu items as the restaurant grows	Requires additional investment. It can be implemented to address recurring errors and meet customer preferences for viewing detailed order information.	Is user-friendly, showing customers exactly what is in their order, which helps reduce confusion	It doesn't provide insights that help with the strategic making decisions.
	3	5	2	5	1
PayRoll & WorkForce Managmen t	Helps optimize labor costs, schedule employees efficiently, and ensure compliance with labor laws.	Can handle an increasing number of employees and more complex scheduling needs	Although it comes with a cost, it saves time and money by optimizing staffing schedules.	It may require some training for staff to fully understand the features.	Provides managers with data on labor costs, staff performance, and scheduling efficiency
	3	5	3	4	5

Source: Created by the company's own information.

According to the criteria applied, the highest ratings were achieved by the following modules: Payment Processing, Inventory Management (25), Accounting (25) Delivery (24), and Payroll & Workforce Management (23). Based on these results, it is recommended to implement these modules to optimize the restaurant's operations and improve efficiency. Although the Kitchen Display System is important for enhancing kitchen operations, it could be implemented at a later stage, after the more critical modules have been established. Additionally, while the Customer Facing Display is useful, it is not critical at this stage and can be considered for future implementation based on the company's needs.

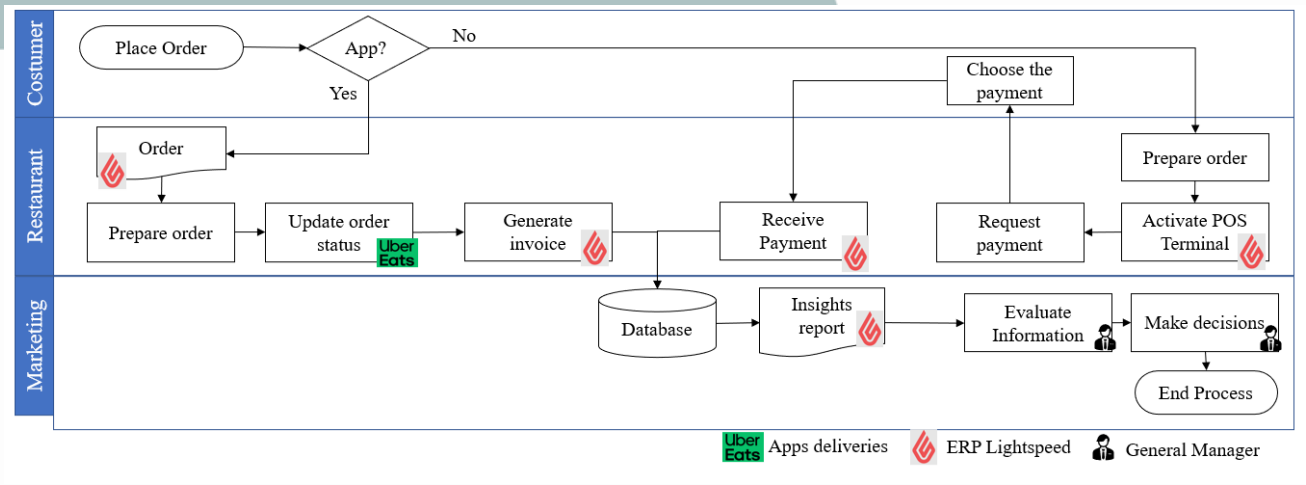
Process and capability alignment

Figure 11. Flowchart from Order Taking in the Restaurant to Accounting



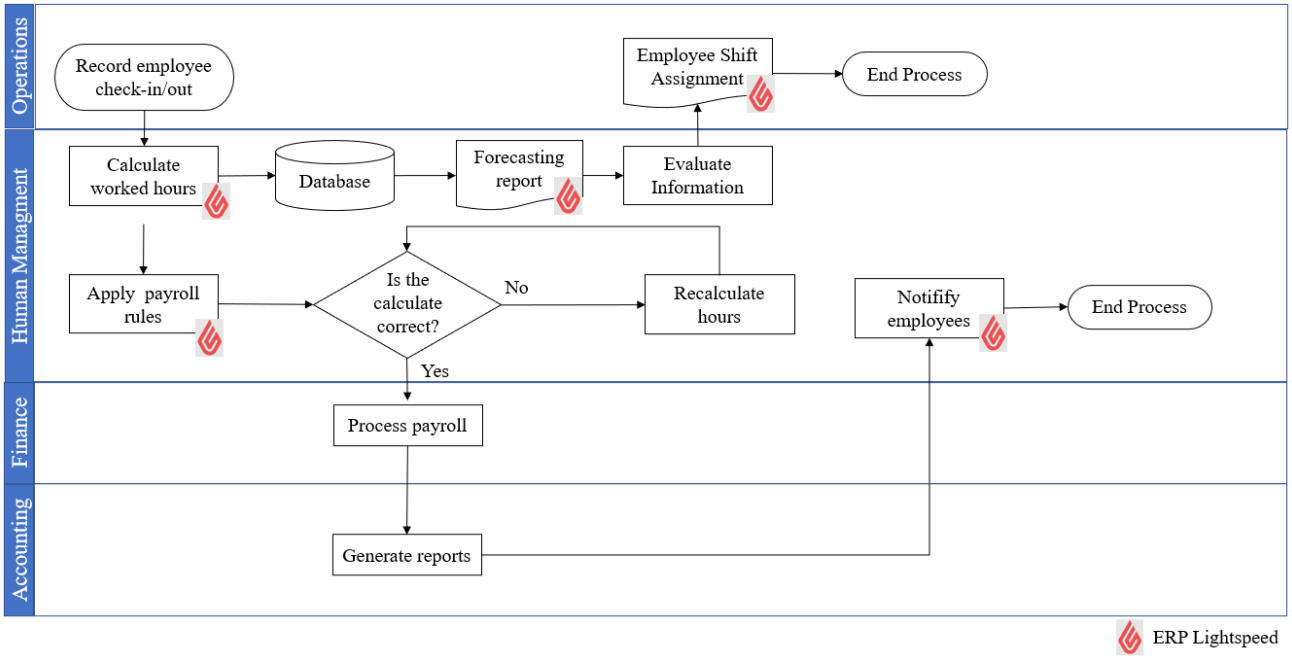
Source: Created by the company's own information.

Figure 12. Flowchart from Order Taking in the Restaurant to Marketing analysis



Source: Created by the company's own information.

Figure 13. Flowchart from Employee Record Management to Shift Assignment and Payroll Processing



Source: Created by the company's own information.

Identity data > information > decision flow enabled by the module

Table 8. Decision Flow enabled by the module.

Module	Data collection	Data Processing	Information Generation	Decision Support
Payment Processing	Collects customer payment details (cash, card, mobile payments).	Processes transactions in real time, including payment authorization and receipt generation.	Generates sales reports, payment logs, and transaction summaries.	Supports decisions on sales trends, payment methods to prioritize, and reconciliation of accounts.
Inventory Management	Tracks stock levels, ingredient usage, and supplier orders.	Processes inventory updates, monitors restocking needs, and identifies discrepancies or waste.	Provides inventory status reports, reorder alerts, and waste analysis.	Helps decide on restocking schedules, inventory optimization, and minimizing losses from spoilage or overstock.
Accounting	Collects financial data such as sales, expenses, and payroll inputs.	Processes financial transactions, including categorizing expenses and reconciling accounts.	Generates financial statements, profit/loss summaries, and tax preparation documents.	Informs decisions on budgeting, profitability analysis, and compliance with financial regulations.
Delivery	Captures online orders and delivery details from platforms like UberEats or DoorDash.	Consolidates delivery orders, calculates delivery charges, and optimizes routing information.	Generates delivery performance reports, customer feedback data, and order completion logs.	Guides decisions on delivery efficiency improvements, menu items suitable for delivery, and delivery zone adjustments to increase reach and profitability
Payroll & Workforce Management	Records employee work hours, shift schedules, and payroll-related information (e.g., tips and benefits).	Automates payroll calculations, generates tax documentation, and analyzes labor cost trends.	Produces pay stubs, labor cost reports, and employee performance summaries.	Aids decisions on labor allocation, staffing adjustments, and optimizing payroll processes to align with labor laws and cost-effectiveness.

Source: Created by the company's own information.

Evaluate the potential use of emerging technologies (e.g., IoT, AI, blockchain) to enhance the chosen business function further)

To sustain its competitive edge in the fast-paced food service industry, Burrito Gringo could strategically implement emerging technologies such as IoT, AI, and blockchain to strengthen various aspects of its business operations. These suggestions align seamlessly with the goals and operational strategies outlined in the company's existing management systems and growth objectives.

1. IoT (Internet of Things) for Enhanced Operational Efficiency:

• Inventory Management: By employing IoT-enabled sensors, Burrito Gringo could monitor inventory levels in real-time. This technology would provide automated alerts when stock levels are low, helping reduce food waste and streamline reordering processes—aligning with the company's current emphasis on accurate inventory tracking (e.g., Resto Soft's role in basic stock management). This step could advance existing efforts and provide a more robust solution for inventory oversight.

• Equipment Monitoring: Integrating smart kitchen appliances capable of sending real-time data on usage and maintenance needs could minimize downtime and prolong equipment lifespan, aligning with Burrito Gringo's commitment to operational efficiency and quality management practices.

• Customer Experience: IoT technology could be extended to include self-service kiosks and automated ordering systems, enhancing order accuracy and reducing wait times. This would support the current digital optimization practices, such as using platforms like Uber Eats and in-store POS systems.

2. AI (Artificial Intelligence) for Data-Driven Insights and Personalization:

• Sales and Customer Insights: AI-driven analytics can be invaluable for processing customer data to identify trends, predict demand, and optimize staffing schedules. This would align with Burrito Gringo's ongoing pursuit of detailed sales reports and decision-making processes that ensure peak operational efficiency (as noted in its exploration of reporting tools like Touch Bistro).

• Personalized Marketing: Implementing AI to analyze customer behavior would enable Burrito Gringo to tailor promotions and loyalty programs, enhancing customer engagement and loyalty. This approach complements the current use of data insights for targeted marketing and promotions.

• Chatbots for Customer Service: To further enhance customer experience, AI-powered chatbots could be integrated into Burrito Gringo's online platforms, providing instant support and reducing staff workload. This step would build on the company's strategy of enhancing customer satisfaction through efficient digital tools.

3. Blockchain for Enhanced Transparency and Trust:

• Supply Chain Management: Utilizing blockchain technology would enable Burrito Gringo to trace food sourcing transparently, ensuring the brand's commitment to high-quality, fresh ingredients is verifiable. This innovation could strengthen customer trust and align with the company's sustainability policy by promoting responsible sourcing and minimizing waste.

• Loyalty Programs: Blockchain can support secure, tamper-proof digital loyalty programs where customers earn and redeem points seamlessly. This advanced solution would align with Burrito Gringo's current efforts to foster loyalty through rewards and personalized incentives.

By strategically adopting these technologies, Burrito Gringo would enhance operational efficiency, optimize customer experiences, and improve supply chain transparency. These steps align with the company's existing goals of maintaining high-quality service and operational excellence, while positioning itself as a forward-thinking leader in Ottawa's competitive food service market.

2. References

Gabrani, N. (2024, August 5). *What Is a Value Chain? Definition, Benefits, and Examples*. Retrieved from SalesForce: https://www.salesforce.com/blog/value-chain/#:~:text=The%20value%20chain%20identifies%20each,to%20improve%20its%20competitive%20advantage.